BrightPeak Ads

META ADS · FACEBOOK + INSTAGRAM

The Black Friday Meta Ads Checklist

A week-by-week prep list to get your ad account, tracking, creatives and budgets ready before the biggest shopping weekend of the year.

BLACK FRIDAY	CYBER MONDAY
Fri, Nov 27, 2026	Mon, Nov 30, 2026

Black Friday rewards the advertisers who prepared early. During peak week, ad reviews can take longer, competition for attention rises, and there is little time to fix a broken pixel or a locked account. The work that matters most happens in the weeks before the sale.

Use this checklist to work through each phase in order. Tick off every box, and anything you can't tick is your to-do list for this week.

PHASE 1	PHASE 2	PHASE 3	PHASE 4	PHASE 5
4+ weeks out	2–3 weeks out	Launch week	During the sale	After the sale

> Meta's tools and menu names change often. If a setting mentioned here looks different in your account, look for the closest current equivalent in Ads Manager, Events Manager or your business settings.

PHASE 1 4+ weeks out: start now

ACCOUNT HEALTH & ACCESS

- [ ] **Have at least two admins on your business portfolio (Business Manager), both with two-factor authentication.**
  If one person is locked out or unavailable during the sale, someone else can still manage ads and billing.
- [ ] **Add a backup payment method to the ad account.**
  A declined card can pause delivery; a backup keeps ads running while you sort it out.
- [ ] **Check the account spending limit and raise or remove it if needed.**
  A forgotten limit can stop all campaigns at the worst possible moment.

TRACKING

- [ ] **Confirm the Meta Pixel and the Conversions API are both sending Purchase events.**
  Sending from browser and server together gives Meta a more complete picture of your sales.
- [ ] **Pass the same event_id from the Pixel and the Conversions API for each event.**
  Matching IDs let Meta deduplicate, so one purchase isn't counted twice.
- [ ] **Run a test purchase and check it in Events Manager (Test Events).**
  Verify the event fires once, with the correct value and currency, before real money is on the line.
- [ ] **Verify your website domain in your business settings.**
  Domain verification confirms you own the site and helps with event and link control.

CATALOG (E-COMMERCE)

- [ ] **Check your product catalog or feed for errors, out-of-stock items and correct prices.**
  Catalog ads pull directly from the feed, so mistakes there show up in your ads.

PHASE 2 2–3 weeks out

- [ ] **Build and upload your Black Friday creatives early so they clear ad review.**
  Review times can stretch during busy periods; approved ads can be scheduled ahead.
- [ ] **Prepare offer-specific variations (discount, bundle, free shipping) in feed and Reels sizes.**
  Several ready-made angles let you swap in what works without building from scratch.
- [ ] **Warm up audiences: website visitors, Facebook and Instagram engagers, and past customers.**
  People who already know you are often the easiest to bring back during a sale.
- [ ] **Upload customer lists only where you have the proper consent to use them for ads.**
  Keep your audience data compliant with Meta's terms and privacy rules.
- [ ] **Review Advantage+ creative enhancements and turn off any you haven't approved.**
  Automatic edits to images, text or music should match your brand and offer.

PHASE 3 Launch week

- [ ] **Launch sale campaigns several days before the peak.**
  This gives delivery time to stabilize before Black Friday traffic arrives.
- [ ] **Plan budgets and raise them gradually rather than in one large jump.**
  Steady increases are less disruptive to delivery than sudden big changes.
- [ ] **Use budget scheduling for peak days if it is available in your account.**
  Pre-set increases happen on time, even if nobody is at a desk.
- [ ] **Test landing page speed, checkout and every promo code on mobile.**
  Many shoppers browse on their phones; a slow page or broken code wastes paid traffic.
- [ ] **Lock in your structure: avoid big edits once peak days begin.**
  Finalize campaigns, ad sets and offers now so you aren't rebuilding mid-sale.

PHASE 4 During the sale: Nov 27–30

- [ ] **Check spend pacing and frequency at least once a day.**
  Catch overspending, underdelivery or ad fatigue early.
- [ ] **Watch for disapproved ads and rejected edits.**
  A disapproval during peak days can quietly stop your best ad.
- [ ] **Keep a backup ad set approved and ready to switch on.**
  If something is paused or underperforming, you can react in minutes.
- [ ] **Avoid major edits that send ad sets back into the learning phase.**
  Significant changes can restart learning and make delivery less stable.

PHASE 5 After the sale

- [ ] **Retarget engagers and cart abandoners into Cyber Week and December offers.**
  Interest built over the weekend can still turn into holiday sales.
- [ ] **Save your results, winning creatives and lessons learned.**
  Next year's plan starts with what you learned this year.

Want a second pair of eyes on your ad account before the rush?

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